NEC 2026 TASK SUBMISSION

Know Your Motivation

Nine individual motivations, expectations and the changes Vanguard CUAP will bring to CUAP E-Cell

CUAP E-CELL

IDEAS TO IMPACT. SKILLS TO SUCCESS.

NEC ID	NEC2644385
College Name	Central University of Andhra Pradesh
NEC Team Name	Vanguard CUAP
E-Cell Name	CUAP E-Cell
Team Leader	Sumant Ghantewar
Number of Members	9

TEAM PURPOSE

One team. Nine motivations. One shared direction.

Our collective vision is to make CUAP a nationally recognised hub of innovation, entrepreneurship and career excellence - a place where students identify real problems, test ideas, build useful solutions, understand financial value, use technology responsibly and connect with mentors, partners and opportunities.

TEAM STRUCTURE

TEAM MEMBER	ACCOUNTABLE ROLE
Sumant Ghantewar	President & Strategy Lead
Avilash CJ	Vice President & Chief Technology Officer (CTO)
Nandu	Chief Financial Officer (CFO) & Head of Finance and Investment
S. Sanjay Kumar	Head of AI Research & Machine Learning
Jayanth Reddy Ragipindi	Head of Research, Data & Documentation
N Vamshi Krishna	Head of Marketing, Branding & People Operations
Sankepalli Nagatilak Datta	Head of Operations & Event Management
Aditya Raj	Head of Public Relations & Outreach
Shivraj	Head of Corporate Relations & Sponsorship

What keeps us motivated

We are motivated by visible student progress: a problem understood more clearly, a prototype tested, a budget improved, a skill practised, a mentor connection created, a partnership built or an event delivered well. Setbacks will be treated as feedback. Clear ownership, honest measurement, responsible use of resources and mutual support will help us continue through difficult periods without losing the larger purpose.

MEMBER 01 / INDIVIDUAL STATEMENT



Sumant Ghantewar

President & Strategy Lead

Executive Leadership • Strategic Planning • Organizational Vision

Motivation: 151 words | Expectations & changes: 183 words

KEY SKILLS

Leadership & Team Building; Strategic Planning; Decision Making; Public Speaking; Negotiation; Networking; Conflict Resolution; Vision Setting

My individual motivation

I am motivated to lead CUAP E-Cell because I want student ideas to move beyond conversation and become disciplined, visible outcomes. Entrepreneurship interests me because it combines imagination with responsibility: a team must identify a real problem, make choices with limited resources, communicate clearly, and continue even when the first attempt fails. My strengths in leadership, strategic planning, decision making, public speaking, negotiation, networking, conflict resolution and vision setting can help the team remain united around a common purpose. I also see this responsibility as an opportunity to grow into a more patient and accountable leader who listens before deciding and gives every member space to contribute. During difficult periods, my motivation will come from the larger goal of creating a lasting entrepreneurial culture at CUAP. Success for me is not only winning NEC tasks; it is building a team and system that future students can trust, improve and carry forward.

My expectations and the changes I will bring

I expect CUAP E-Cell to become a year-round, student-led platform rather than a group that becomes active only for competitions or occasional events. Students should receive a clear pathway from problem identification and skill building to validation, prototyping, mentoring, financial planning, pitching and external exposure. The main change I will bring is structured governance with visible ownership. At the beginning of each cycle, the team will define a limited number of priorities, responsible owners, timelines, resources and success indicators. Short weekly reviews will surface delays early, while a monthly strategy review will connect departmental work to our shared vision. I will encourage transparent decision making by evaluating major activities on student value, feasibility, cost, risk and expected impact. I also want disagreements to be handled respectfully, with decisions recorded so that the team does not repeat the same discussions. Post-activity reviews will convert setbacks into specific improvements instead of blame. By creating continuity, accountability and a culture of mutual support, I aim to make CUAP E-Cell capable of delivering meaningful initiatives consistently and representing the university with credibility at NEC 2026 and beyond.

My three working commitments

1. Publish clear priorities, owners, timelines and measurable outcomes.
2. Conduct focused reviews that remove blockers and strengthen coordination.
3. Protect the long-term vision while supporting every department head.



Avilash CJ

Vice President & Chief Technology Officer (CTO)

Executive Leadership • Technology • Digital Innovation

Motivation: 162 words | Expectations & changes: 187 words

KEY SKILLS

Artificial Intelligence; Full Stack Development; React; Node.js; Python; n8n Automation; API Integration; Database Management; UI/UX; Prompt Engineering; Cloud Deployment; Digital Infrastructure; Project Management

My individual motivation

I am motivated to be part of CUAP E-Cell because technology can turn good intentions into scalable systems that students can actually use. Many campus initiatives depend on manual forms, scattered files and repeated follow-ups, which can slow the team and reduce the quality of participation. My experience in artificial intelligence, full-stack development, React, Node.js, Python, workflow automation, API integration, databases, UI/UX, prompt engineering and cloud deployment gives me an opportunity to build practical solutions for these problems. I want to use technology not as a display feature, but as an enabling layer for registrations, communication, dashboards, idea tracking, mentor connections and knowledge management. As Vice President, I am also motivated by cross-functional leadership: understanding the needs of each department and helping them work together. When a build fails or a technical plan changes, I will remain motivated by iteration, user feedback and the belief that every reliable system we create can save time and expand access for many students.

My expectations and the changes I will bring

I expect CUAP E-Cell to develop a dependable digital backbone that supports its activities throughout the year. The first change I will bring is a simple, mobile-friendly E-Cell website that clearly explains opportunities, displays events, captures registrations and showcases student ideas and achievements. The second change is workflow automation. Repetitive tasks such as confirmation emails, attendance updates, form consolidation, reminders and internal approvals can be connected through tools such as n8n and APIs, reducing manual errors. I will work with the President and department heads to build dashboards for task progress, event registration, outreach conversion and submission readiness. A structured database will ensure that student, mentor, partner and project information is secure, searchable and reusable. I also want basic cybersecurity and access-control practices so sensitive information is not shared casually. For innovation activities, I will support rapid prototypes, AI-enabled tools and digital demonstrations that help students test ideas early. Technology choices will be guided by usability, maintenance, privacy and long-term value rather than novelty. Through documentation and peer training, I will ensure that systems remain understandable to future teams and do not depend on only one person.

My three working commitments

1. Build and maintain a reliable digital platform for E-Cell activities.
2. Automate repetitive workflows while protecting data and access.
3. Translate departmental needs into practical, maintainable technology.



Nandu

Chief Financial Officer (CFO) & Head of Finance and Investment

Finance & Investment • Corporate Accounting • Financial Strategy

Motivation: 159 words | Expectations & changes: 197 words

KEY SKILLS

Financial Accounting; Corporate Accounting; Financial Management; Financial Statements; Ratio Analysis; MS Excel; Financial Modelling; Company Valuation

My individual motivation

I am motivated to join CUAP E-Cell because every entrepreneurial idea must eventually answer practical financial questions. A strong concept can fail when costs are unclear, resources are used without planning, or decisions are made without understanding value and risk. My interests in financial accounting, corporate accounting, financial management, financial statements, ratio analysis, Excel, financial modelling and company valuation allow me to help the team approach money with discipline. I want students to see finance not as a barrier, but as a tool that helps them test feasibility, compare alternatives and communicate credibility to mentors, sponsors and investors. The E-Cell also gives me a chance to apply classroom knowledge to real budgets, sponsorship plans and startup cases. When funds are limited or a proposal is rejected, I will stay motivated by finding more efficient options and improving the financial logic. My goal is to create trust through accuracy, transparency and responsible use of every resource placed with the team.

My expectations and the changes I will bring

I expect CUAP E-Cell to maintain transparent and decision-oriented financial practices from the beginning of every activity. The first change I will bring is an annual and event-wise budgeting system that separates expected income, committed expenditure, actual expenditure and outstanding obligations. Every proposal should include a basic cost estimate, funding source, financial risk and approval status before execution begins. I will prepare simple Excel templates for budgets, reimbursement records, sponsorship receipts and financial summaries so information remains consistent. For student venture support, I want to introduce basic unit economics, break-even thinking, cash-flow planning, ratio interpretation and early-stage valuation exercises in an understandable format. This will help teams test whether an idea can sustain itself and improve the quality of pitches. I will coordinate closely with Corporate Relations so sponsorship commitments, deliverables and utilisation are documented correctly. Periodic financial reports will be shared with leadership, and supporting bills or records will be preserved for accountability. I also expect the E-Cell to distinguish between necessary investment and avoidable spending. Through careful analysis and honest reporting, I aim to help the team use limited resources effectively, build sponsor confidence and teach students that financial responsibility is central to sustainable entrepreneurship.

My three working commitments

1. Maintain transparent budgets, records and financial reports.
2. Support student ideas with practical costing, modelling and valuation.
3. Ensure sponsorship funds are linked to clear deliverables and evidence.



S. Sanjay Kumar

Head of AI Research & Machine Learning

Artificial Intelligence • Machine Learning • Research & Innovation

Motivation: 166 words | Expectations & changes: 194 words

KEY SKILLS

Research; Python; Artificial Intelligence; Machine Learning; Problem Solving; Communication

My individual motivation

I am motivated to be part of CUAP E-Cell because artificial intelligence can help students explore new solutions when it is connected to real problems and responsible experimentation. My interests in research, Python, artificial intelligence, machine learning, problem solving and communication fit a role where ideas must be investigated, tested and explained clearly. I want to help students move beyond only talking about AI by building small prototypes that demonstrate usefulness in education, campus services, entrepreneurship, data analysis or community needs. The E-Cell offers a space where technical learning can meet business thinking, user feedback and teamwork. I am also motivated by the challenge of making complex concepts understandable to non-technical members so that AI projects remain collaborative. When an experiment produces weak results, I will treat it as information rather than failure, revise the assumptions and test again. My aim is to develop practical research habits, encourage responsible use of AI and show how technology can create value when guided by evidence and human needs.

My expectations and the changes I will bring

I expect CUAP E-Cell to create an environment where AI and machine learning are used for purposeful innovation, not only as fashionable terms. The main change I will bring is a small AI research and prototyping workflow. Each project will begin with a clearly defined problem, intended user, available data, success measure and ethical consideration. I will develop or coordinate Python-based prototypes, test their performance and document limitations honestly. Together with the CTO, I will identify AI applications that can improve E-Cell operations, such as idea classification, feedback analysis, content assistance, information retrieval or simple recommendation systems. Together with the Research Head, I will ensure that datasets and conclusions are handled carefully and that privacy is respected. I also want to conduct beginner-friendly sessions that introduce students to AI problem framing, model basics, prompt design, responsible use and prototype presentation. Projects will be reviewed not only for technical accuracy but also for usefulness, feasibility and potential entrepreneurial value. Clear demonstrations, short technical notes and explainable results will help non-technical stakeholders understand the work. Through these practices, I hope CUAP E-Cell becomes known for responsible experimentation and for converting emerging technology into practical student-led solutions.

My three working commitments

1. Define clear problems and measurable objectives before building models.
2. Develop practical prototypes and document results and limitations honestly.
3. Make AI learning accessible through demonstrations and peer sessions.



Jayanth Reddy Ragipindi

Head of Research, Data & Documentation

Research & Analytics • Data Management • Documentation

Motivation: 162 words | Expectations & changes: 189 words

KEY SKILLS

Market Research; Data Analysis; Report Writing; Documentation Standards; MS Excel; Data Visualization; Critical Thinking; Survey Design

My individual motivation

I am motivated to join CUAP E-Cell because sound entrepreneurial decisions begin with curiosity, evidence and clear documentation. Students may have creative ideas, but they often need support to identify the actual problem, understand users, compare alternatives and present proof. My interests in market research, data analysis, report writing, documentation standards, Excel, data visualization, critical thinking and survey design allow me to help bridge that gap. I enjoy converting scattered information into a structured story that a team can use for action. The E-Cell will also challenge me to improve my research judgement, accuracy and ability to work within deadlines. When progress becomes difficult, I will remain motivated by asking what the data is showing and what small experiment should be conducted next. Good documentation also protects the team from repeating mistakes and helps future members continue work without starting from zero. My goal is to make research a practical decision tool for every department, not a formality completed only for submissions.

My expectations and the changes I will bring

I expect CUAP E-Cell to build a reliable knowledge system that supports events, campaigns, partnerships and student ventures. The change I will bring is a simple research-to-action process. Before a major initiative, the team will define the question, target group, information required and decision the research must support. Surveys and interviews will use clear questions, and datasets will be checked before analysis. I will maintain an organised repository with consistent file names, versions, dates and responsible owners so that evidence can be found quickly. For events, I want to introduce registration analysis, participant expectations, post-event feedback and a short impact summary. For student ideas, I will support problem validation, competitor mapping, user research and basic opportunity sizing. Findings will be converted into concise briefs, charts and recommendations that other department heads can immediately use. I also expect the E-Cell to respect participant privacy and report weak or negative findings honestly. Task progress and submission evidence will be documented systematically, reducing last-minute confusion. By strengthening research quality and institutional memory, I aim to improve decisions, support credible proposals and demonstrate CUAP E-Cell's impact to students, faculty, mentors and external partners.

My three working commitments

1. Create standard research, survey and impact-report templates.
2. Maintain clean datasets and a searchable evidence repository.
3. Convert findings into clear recommendations for each department.



N Vamshi Krishna

Head of Marketing, Branding & People Operations

Marketing • Branding • People Operations

Motivation: 166 words | Expectations & changes: 189 words

KEY SKILLS

Social Media Marketing; Content Creation; Brand Strategy; Canva; People Management; Communication; Community Building; Campaign Planning

My individual motivation

I am motivated to be part of CUAP E-Cell because entrepreneurship grows when people can see an opportunity, understand it and feel invited to participate. A strong idea can remain unnoticed if it is not communicated well, and a capable team can lose energy when members do not feel connected to the mission. My interests in social media marketing, content creation, brand strategy, Canva design, people management, communication, community building and campaign planning allow me to work on both sides of this challenge. I want to create stories that make innovation approachable while helping the internal team remain organised and motivated. The E-Cell gives me a practical setting to test campaigns, learn from audience response and improve through real responsibility. During difficult phases, I will remain motivated by the people behind the numbers: a student who discovers a useful opportunity, a volunteer who finds the right role, or an idea team that gains its first audience. I want our communication to build trust, not only visibility.

My expectations and the changes I will bring

I expect CUAP E-Cell to become a recognisable, inclusive and active campus community with consistent communication throughout the year. The first change I will bring is a monthly content system linked to our priorities. Every campaign will identify its audience, message, format, owner, publishing date and expected action. Our social channels should explain what the E-Cell offers, show real student work and guide interested students towards a clear next step. I will coordinate with Research for facts and performance data, with Public Relations for distribution, and with Technology for website and registration integration. Reach, engagement, enquiries, registrations and continued participation will be reviewed so future communication improves. The second change is a stronger member experience. New volunteers should receive an orientation, role description, communication norms and a meaningful first task. Regular appreciation, peer learning and brief check-ins can maintain motivation without creating unnecessary control. I also want a consistent visual and written identity that reflects our promise of turning ideas into impact and skills into success. Students should experience the same clarity and energy whether they see a post, visit the website, attend an event or join the team.

My three working commitments

1. Run a consistent content calendar connected to E-Cell goals.
2. Track meaningful campaign response, not only likes and impressions.
3. Build a welcoming onboarding and engagement process for volunteers.



Sankepalli Nagatilak Datta

Head of Operations & Event Management

Operations • Event Management • Logistics

Motivation: 162 words | Expectations & changes: 192 words

KEY SKILLS

Event Planning; Logistics Management; Vendor Coordination; Time Management; Problem Solving; Team Coordination; Event Budgeting; Risk Management

My individual motivation

I am motivated to join CUAP E-Cell because good ideas earn trust only when they are executed reliably. Entrepreneurship involves uncertainty, changing requirements and limited resources, so planning and practical problem solving are as important as creativity. My strengths in event planning, logistics management, vendor coordination, time management, problem solving, team coordination, event budgeting and risk management can help convert plans into organised action. I enjoy understanding what must happen, who is responsible, what could go wrong and how the team can respond. The E-Cell gives me an opportunity to learn by doing through events, volunteer coordination and continuous improvement. Difficult days are unavoidable, especially when permissions are delayed, schedules change or resources are unavailable. In those moments, my motivation will come from remaining calm, protecting the objective and finding the most workable next step. I want students to remember CUAP E-Cell activities as purposeful, well managed and respectful of their time, while developing my own ability to lead execution under pressure.

My expectations and the changes I will bring

I expect CUAP E-Cell to become known for dependable execution and continuous improvement. Every activity should have a clear objective, realistic schedule, resource plan, assigned responsibilities, budget coordination and quality check. The main change I will bring is a repeatable event-management system that remains simple enough for student teams to use. For each event, I will prepare a checklist covering permissions, venue, speakers, equipment, communication, registrations, volunteer duties, vendor requirements, contingency plans and closure. A visible risk and dependency tracker will help the team identify issues before they become emergencies. I also want a readiness review before launch so content, links, equipment, participant instructions and responsible contacts are verified. During execution, updates should be short and decision-focused, allowing members to respond quickly. After completion, we will record attendance, outcomes, problems, feedback, financial inputs and recommended improvements. I expect departments to share requirements early and respect agreed deadlines, while operations must remain adaptable when genuine changes occur. Templates and lessons will be stored for future teams. These changes will make CUAP E-Cell more professional without making it bureaucratic, allowing creative teams to focus on value while participants receive a smooth and high-quality experience.

My three working commitments

1. Use practical checklists for every event and major activity.
2. Track risks, dependencies, readiness and closure status.
3. Document lessons so each event improves on the previous one.



Aditya Raj

Head of Public Relations & Outreach

Public Relations • Outreach • Communication

Motivation: 168 words | Expectations & changes: 194 words

KEY SKILLS

Public Speaking; Networking; Media Relations; Email Communication; Relationship Building; Professional Writing; Presentation Skills; Cross-Team Coordination

My individual motivation

I am motivated to be part of CUAP E-Cell because opportunities create impact only when they reach the right people and are communicated with credibility. Many students have talent and ambition but may not know where to begin, whom to approach or how an E-Cell can support them. I want to make that first connection easier. My strengths in public speaking, networking, media relations, email communication, relationship building, professional writing, presentation and cross-team coordination suit a public-facing role. I am interested in understanding what different student groups and external stakeholders need and presenting E-Cell activities in language that is clear and relevant. The role will help me become a better listener, representative and relationship builder. Rejection and low response are normal in outreach, so my motivation cannot depend only on immediate success. I will stay focused by learning from every interaction, improving our message and following up consistently. I want CUAP E-Cell to be visible as an open pathway for any student willing to learn, experiment and contribute.

My expectations and the changes I will bring

I expect CUAP E-Cell to build strong relationships across departments, student communities, faculty, alumni, other colleges and the wider entrepreneurial ecosystem. Outreach should be continuous, targeted and respectful rather than a burst of promotion before an event. The key change I will bring is a structured stakeholder and outreach system. We will maintain contact lists, record the purpose of each interaction, track follow-ups and measure movement from awareness to enquiry, registration, attendance and continued engagement. For major activities, I will work with Research to identify suitable audiences and with Marketing to prepare accurate messages and creatives. Department coordinators and student ambassadors can help reach learners who may not actively follow E-Cell channels. I will also liaise professionally with NEC 2026 and E-Cell IIT Bombay coordinators, ensuring that communication, deadlines and clarifications are handled properly. Public information about dates, eligibility, benefits, expectations and next steps must be easy to understand. Outreach results will be reviewed regularly so we can improve channels and messages when response is weak. By treating every interaction as a relationship rather than a transaction, I aim to increase participation, strengthen credibility and create a broad campus network around innovation and entrepreneurship.

My three working commitments

1. Maintain accurate stakeholder records and disciplined follow-ups.
2. Make every opportunity clear, inclusive and easy to act upon.
3. Represent CUAP E-Cell professionally in external communication.



Shivraj

Head of Corporate Relations & Sponsorship

Corporate Relations • Sponsorship • Business Development

Motivation: 163 words | Expectations & changes: 189 words

KEY SKILLS

Cold Outreach; Negotiation; Proposal Writing; Relationship Management; Business Development; Persuasion; CRM Tools; Financial Acumen

My individual motivation

I am motivated to join CUAP E-Cell because student entrepreneurs grow faster when they are connected to organisations and people who can provide experience, networks, resources and honest guidance. A college E-Cell should not operate in isolation; it should become a trusted bridge between campus talent and the wider entrepreneurial ecosystem. My strengths in cold outreach, negotiation, proposal writing, relationship management, business development, persuasion, CRM tools and financial understanding fit the responsibility of building that bridge. I want to learn how to understand a partner's priorities, communicate mutual value and maintain professional relationships over time. Rejection is a normal part of sponsorship and business development, so I will remain motivated by improving the proposal, approaching the right organisation and following up with discipline. The opportunity to secure support for student activities, mentors and promising ideas gives the role a meaningful purpose. My goal is not only to obtain funds, but to create partnerships that offer knowledge, exposure and long-term value to CUAP students.

My expectations and the changes I will bring

I expect CUAP E-Cell to build a credible and diversified external partnership network involving companies, founders, incubators, professional bodies, mentors, alumni and potential sponsors. The main change I will bring is a structured corporate-relations pipeline. Potential partners will be categorised by relevance, relationship stage, contact history, next action and expected value. Sponsorship proposals will not be generic requests; each will explain the student audience, activity objective, visibility or engagement offered, budget need, evidence plan and expected outcomes. I will coordinate with Finance to ensure proposed amounts and utilisation are realistic, with Research to include credible data, with Marketing to define communication deliverables, and with the President for strategic approval. Follow-ups and agreements will be recorded through a simple CRM so relationships are not lost when team members change. I also want to develop non-financial partnerships that provide mentors, speakers, internships, workplace exposure, software support or incubation access. After every collaboration, the team will share evidence and a professional acknowledgement with the partner. Through transparent commitments and consistent relationship management, I aim to strengthen sponsor confidence and create an ecosystem in which CUAP students can access opportunities beyond the campus.

My three working commitments

1. Maintain a disciplined partner, sponsor and follow-up pipeline.
2. Prepare customised proposals built on mutual value and evidence.
3. Develop long-term relationships, including non-financial support.

Nine practical changes our team will bring

01	**Strategic governance**	Annual priorities, clear owners, short reviews and measurable outcomes.
02	**Digital infrastructure**	A useful website, registration systems, dashboards, automation and secure records.
03	**Financial discipline**	Transparent budgets, sponsorship accounting, financial modelling and responsible spending.
04	**AI innovation**	Problem-led AI/ML research, practical prototypes, responsible use and student demonstrations.
05	**Evidence and documentation**	Market research, clean data, impact reports and a searchable knowledge repository.
06	**Consistent brand and community**	Year-round communication, clear campaigns, volunteer onboarding and engagement.
07	**Reliable event execution**	Checklists, logistics plans, risk tracking, readiness reviews and post-event learning.
08	**Inclusive outreach**	Department networks, student ambassadors, professional communication and follow-up tracking.
09	**Partnership ecosystem**	Structured corporate outreach, customised proposals, mentors, sponsors and long-term relationships.

Shared operating principle

One owner, many collaborators. The member whose role is closest to the final outcome remains accountable, while other departments provide defined support. This keeps ownership clear without limiting teamwork.

Final video link

https://drive.google.com/file/d/1545QMeFqiMmZUO-GeqZvDkQwgO3lpuln/view?usp=sharing

Know Your Motivation - Submission Details

1. Team Details

NEC ID	NEC2644385
College Name	Central University of Andhra Pradesh
NEC Team Name	Vanguard CUAP
E-Cell Name	CUAP E-Cell
Team Leader	Sumant Ghantewar
Number of Members	9

2. Required Submission Links

Team Video Link (3-4 minutes)	https://drive.google.com/file/d/1545QMeFqiMmZUO-GeqZvDkQwgO3lpuln/view?usp=sharing

3. Individual Motivation & Expectations Index

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We will remain self-motivated by focusing on student progress, working with clear ownership and supporting one another through difficult stages.

VANGUARD CUAP

IDEAS TO IMPACT. SKILLS TO SUCCESS.